MODULE 2 · DE-ICING AND ANTI-ICING

Lesson 11: Gate and Remote De-icing Operations

Lesson 11 of 30 · about 7 min

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Compare gate de-icing with remote (pad) de-icing.
- Describe a typical remote de-icing pad procedure.
- Manage the time between treatment and take-off.



Remote pad de-icing brings the treatment closer to the runway.

Two ways to de-ice

	At the gate / stand	Remote pad or central facility
Engines	Normally shut down; APU running	Normally running at idle (per AFM and facility procedure)
Distance to runway	Longer taxi — more holdover time used before take-off	Close to the departure runway — less holdover time used
Communication	Ground crew via interphone or radio	Pad control / de-icing coordinator by radio, then the vehicle operator
Main risks	HOT running out during pushback and taxi	Wrong position on the pad, engines near personnel, confusion between ATC, pad control and the de-icing crew

A typical remote pad procedure

1. Before taxi, check the airport de-icing procedures (charts, NOTAMs, frequencies) and brief the sequence.

2. ATC or the coordinator assigns a pad. Taxi in following the lead-in line and marshaller or stop-position signs, and stop on the stop line.
3. Set the parking brake and configure the aircraft for de-icing. Report "configured" on the pad frequency.
4. Agree the treatment and receive the start call. Hold position — no movement, power or configuration change.
5. Receive the anti-icing code and the "all personnel and equipment clear" call.
6. Only then reconfigure, complete the after de-icing checks, and contact ATC to leave the pad as instructed.

Managing the time to take-off

- Coordinate with ATC before treatment so that you are not de-iced and then held for a long time.
- Taxi at a safe speed with good separation. Avoid the jet blast of the aircraft ahead, which blows snow and slush onto treated surfaces and thins the fluid.
- Some AFMs recommend delaying flap extension until close to the runway when taxiing through slush or snow. Others require flaps to be set before anti-icing so that the surfaces are protected. Follow your FCOM.
- Continuously compare the remaining holdover time with the expected take-off time. If it will not be enough, decide early — a planned return for re-treatment is better than a rushed decision at the holding point.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Gate de-icing uses more holdover time; pad de-icing is closer to the runway but more complex.
- On the pad, stay stationary and configured until “all clear” is received.
- Keep clear of jet blast and compare remaining HOT with the expected take-off time.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

During remote pad de-icing, when may you reconfigure the aircraft and prepare to taxi?

A. As soon as spraying stops

B. When the anti-icing code is received and the de-icing crew confirms all personnel and equipment are clear

C. When ATC gives a taxi clearance

D. When the last de-icing truck starts to move

Answer: B. Reconfiguring or moving is only safe after the treatment is complete, the code is received and the de-icing crew confirms all personnel and equipment are clear.

Training material only. It does not replace the Aircraft Flight Manual, FCOM, QRH, MEL or the Domestic Airlines Operations Manual, which always take precedence.